Cheltenham School District
Disciplinary Expectations and Consequences
Secondary Schools

As outlined in Board Policy 829 (Equity), the equitable administration of school-based discipline at all District schools based on a model of restorative practices rather than punitive measures, when appropriate, is critical to the District's equity efforts and goal of reducing disproportionality in discipline. When possible and appropriate under the circumstances, students will be afforded the opportunity to participate in restorative practices as an alternative to, or in addition to, more traditional forms of discipline.

Examples of restorative practices include, but are not limited to, the following:

- Peer mediation;
- Conferences with counselors;
- Mindfulness exercises;
- Youth court (if available):
- Community building activities;
- Community service;
- Support from appropriate community organizations.

The following chart is a guide detailing the behaviors students are expected to exhibit and the consequences or other measures students can expect when they make poor choices regarding their behavior. It is not meant to be inclusive of all possible kinds of misbehavior; rather, it is a guideline that represents the more common and serious types of misbehavior that may be experienced in a school environment. Students are reminded that school rules are in effect, and students are subject to discipline: (1) while at school; (2) at school-sponsored events, trips, or activities, whether on or away from school property; (3) while traveling to/from school, school-sponsored events, trips, or activities on a vehicle owned, leased, or under the control of the District; and (4) as otherwise permitted by law.

The severity of any consequence or other measures will be proportional to the severity of the infraction, the age of the student, the student's current and prior disciplinary record (including any history of repeat infractions), special circumstances about the incident, including whether the student was an aggressor or victim, as well as any applicable laws or regulations, including, but not limited to, those related to the discipline of students with disabilities.

In cases where exclusionary discipline is required, the District will require that students returning to school from a suspension or expulsion meet with a designated school official to discuss academic and behavioral expectations upon return to school, individuals and resources available to support students, the consequences of future noncompliance with Board Policy and/or school rules, and the number of hours, if any, of counseling required

prior to the student's return to their regular class schedule. When a student has been issued an out-of-school suspension, the student's parent/guardian will be required to attend the re-entry conference with the appropriate school official(s).

Consistent with the Pennsylvania Safe Schools Act, the District and the Cheltenham Police Department have entered into a Memorandum of Understanding which outlines the procedures to be followed when certain incidents contemplated by the Pennsylvania Safe Schools Act occur on school property, at any school sponsored activity, or on a conveyance providing transportation to or from school or a school sponsored activity. The Memorandum of Understanding is attached to Administrative Regulation 225 (Relationship with Law Enforcement). As outlined in more detail in the existing Memorandum of Understanding between the District and the Cheltenham Township Police Department, the parties seek to maintain a safe school environment in a cooperative and mutually supportive manner, but in a way that does not result in an over presence of law enforcement in the school environment. Through the cooperative and supportive efforts of both parties, the parties strive to reduce student referrals to the criminal justice system and eliminate the school to prison pipeline. Parents/guardians and students should be aware that the nature or degree of student misconduct in certain situations may require or necessitate the involvement of law enforcement. The decision to contact law enforcement is one that is not taken lightly, and is generally reserved for the most severe situations or those that require law enforcement notification as a matter of law.

Infraction	**Examples of Expected Conduct**	**Examples of Behavior in Violation of School Rules**	**First Infraction ***	**Repeated Infractions * (Potential Consequences Are In Addition To Those Possible For First Infraction)**
* In general, a school official will contact the parent/guardian of a student who has engaged in a disciplinary violation.				
Academic Infractions				
Academic Dishonesty	Academic honesty; Adherence to academic standards; Integrity in academic research / publishing	Cheating; Plagiarism; Forgery of grades, times, addresses, signatures, or other data on school records	Restorative practices; "0" on assignment; Redo assignment for limited credit; Parental contact by teacher and/or administrator	Parent conference with teacher/administrator; Possible reduction of grade or failure of course
Unauthorized Lateness to or Failure to Attend Class (Class Cut), Detention, or Suspension	Coming to class (including detention or suspension) on time; Adhering to one's school/class schedule and being in designated areas at designated times	Class cut or unauthorized absence from a scheduled detention or suspension; leaving class, a detention or suspension without proper authorization	Restorative practices; Warning; Parent contact; Detention; Loss of school-related privileges; Up to 3 days suspension	Parent conference with teacher/administrator; Possible course grade reduction; Up to 10 days suspension

Property Infractions				
Arson; Unauthorized Burning; Possession of Explosive Materials	Maintaining a safe and orderly school environment; Respect for school property and the property of others	Burning or attempting to burn any part of any building or school property without authorization; Possession of fireworks or other explosive devices (including smoke bombs, stink bombs, or similar instruments capable of bodily harm or damage to school property); Possession of devices capable of starting a fire	Restorative practices; Parental contact; Up to 10 days suspension; Referral for possible expulsion	→
Parking/Vehicle Violations	Following school rules and posted parking and vehicle signs and regulations	Violating school parking lot rules, regulations, or posted signs; Failure to park in designated space; Violating any applicable provision of the Pennsylvania Vehicle Code. Refer to Board Policy # 222 for additional information	Restorative practices; Warning; Parental contact; Loss of privileges; Detention	→
Theft; Vandalism; Littering; Property Offenses (Including Trespassing and Inappropriate Use)	Showing respect for school property and the property of others	Stealing, misappropriating or taking the property of another, including school property; littering; defacing, destroying, altering or tampering with the property of another without permission; trespass or misuse of school property (including books, supplies, equipment, technology devices, etc.)	Restorative practices; Parental contact; Detention, Loss of privileges; Restitution; Up to 10 days suspension; Referral for possible expulsion	→
Infractions Against Others				
Assault; Battery; Fighting	Respecting school staff, students, and visitors; Maintaining appropriate physical contact and conduct; Maintaining a safe and orderly school environment	Physically or verbally attacking any person (includes behavior such as hitting, beating, striking, punching, biting, spitting, grabbing, tripping, etc.); Engaging in hostile bodily contact (The principal may choose not to discipline a student for actions reasonably and appropriately taken demonstrably in self-defense)	Restorative practices; Parental contact; Up to 10 days suspension; Loss of school-related privileges; Referral for possible expulsion	→
Harassment and Bullying; Hazing	Maintaining appropriate physical contact and conduct; Treating others with respect and courtesy	Sexual harassment, bullying, hazing and other forms of prohibited harassment. Refer to School Board Policy # 247 and 248	Restorative practices; Parental contact; Detention; Suspension; Referral for possible expulsion	→

Sexual Contact (Consensual)	Maintaining appropriate physical contact and conduct	Sexual intercourse; Inappropriate public display of affection; groping; inappropriate touching or bodily contact	Restorative practices; Parental contact; Detention; Suspension; Referral for possible expulsion	→
Health, Safety & Welfare Infractions				
Drug and Alcohol Policy Violation (Use /Possession / Sale)	Maintaining an environment free from drugs, alcohol, and other controlled or prohibited substances	Use, possession, sale, distribution, or being under the influence of any controlled substance. Refer to School Board Policy # 227 for additional information	Refer to School Board Policy # 227; Restorative practices	→
Inappropriate Use of Electronic Device / Acceptable Use of Technology Violations	Using technology and electronic devices in accordance with Board Policy and school rules; Maintaining a school environment, conducive to academic instruction	Failing to utilize technology and/or electronic devices in accordance with Board Policy, applicable law or school rules; Using technology or electronic devices in a way that is disruptive to the educational or extracurricular activities of the District, including, but not limited to recording, taking photographs of, or transmitting fights or other disturbances to the school environment, except for the limited purpose of reporting such conduct to a school official; Refer to School Board Policy # 237 and 816 for additional information.	Restorative practices; Warning; Parent contact; Confiscation of device; Detention; Loss of school-related privileges; Up to 3 days suspension	Up to 10 days suspension; Referral for possible expulsion
Gambling; Selling/Distribution of Unauthorized Merchandise	Refraining from engaging in unauthorized activities	The act of gambling for money or valuables; Selling or distribution of unauthorized merchandise without administrative approval	Restorative practices; Warning; Detention; Parent contact; Confiscation of unauthorized merchandise	Up to 10 days suspension
Threatening or Intimidating Conduct; False Alarms; Terrorist Threats/Acts	Maintaining a safe and orderly school environment; Treating others with respect and courtesy; Maintaining a school environment conducive to academic instruction	Engaging in conduct which undermines the safety, security or wellbeing of any person or of school property; threats of violence or harm communicated verbally or in writing; bomb threats; knowingly reporting a false threat; tampering with the fire alarm, fire extinguisher, sprinkler system or other apparatus installed for the prevention of fire or for the safety of the school community or property	Restorative practices; Parental contact; Up to 10 days suspension; Referral for possible expulsion	→

Threat to Health, Morals, Safety or Welfare of Others	Maintaining a safe and orderly school environment, conducive to academic instruction; Respecting school staff, students, and visitors; Maintaining appropriate physical contact and conduct; Following school rules and directions of school officials	Conduct that constitutes a threat to the health, morals, safety or welfare of others	Restorative practices; Parental contact; Detention; Suspension; Referral for possible expulsion	Up to 10 days suspension; Referral for possible expulsion
Weapons & Other Dangerous Items Violation (Possession, Use, Transfer, Sale)	Maintaining a safe and orderly school environment, free from weapons or similar objects	Possession or use of weapon or dangerous item; Refer to School Board Policy # 218.2 for additional information	Restorative practices; Parental contact; Referral for possible expulsion	→
Smoking / Tobacco / Nicotine Violation	Maintaining a safe free from tobacco and nicotine, including nicotine delivery products	Possession or use of tobacco/nicotine products or nicotine delivery devices; Refer to School Board Policy # 223 for additional information	Restorative practices; Parent contact; Up to 10 days suspension	→
Classroom / School Disturbance	Maintaining a safe and orderly school environment, conducive to academic instruction; Respecting school staff, students, and visitors; Following school rules and directions of school officials; Refraining from using profanity; Adhering to one's school/class schedule and being in designated areas at designated times.	Behavior which disrupts or has the potential to disrupt the educational process or regular school operations. Includes loitering, hall pass violations, instigating violence or other violation of Board Policy or school rules, failure to identify or properly identify oneself upon request of a school official, failure to obey instructions of a school official, insubordination, profanity or inappropriate language, gesture, or action, disrespectful behavior, sleeping in class, other violations of school rules not listed in this chart.	Restorative practices; Warning; Parent contact; Detention; Loss of school-related privileges; Up to 3 days suspension	Up to 10 days suspension; Referral for possible expulsion